

Year 4 Reading Comprehension - The Lighthouse Keeper's Note

Name: _____ Date: _____

ACARA v9.0: AC9E4LY05 - use comprehension strategies to build literal and inferred meaning, expand ideas and evaluate texts.

Learning Intention

Read a mystery-style narrative and use clues to make sensible inferences.

Reading Strategy

Track clues as you read. Ask: What do I know? What can I infer?

Vocabulary Helper

lantern - a light carried or hung for brightness

harbour - a sheltered place where boats can stay

faded - less bright or clear than before

The Lighthouse Keeper's Note

The old lighthouse stood above the harbour like a tall white pencil. Every school holiday, Jai visited his aunt nearby, but he had never been allowed inside the locked tower. This time, the council had opened it for visitors, and Jai climbed the narrow stairs with his cousin Elsie.

Halfway up, Elsie spotted a loose brick beside a small window. Behind it was a folded note, yellow at the edges. The writing was faded, but they could read one line: 'When the lantern fails, look to the southern star.'

Jai wondered if it was a warning. At the top of the lighthouse, a guide explained that keepers once used lanterns to help ships find the harbour safely. If the main light failed, they needed another way to signal. Elsie looked out across the sea and pointed south. A metal star was fixed to the railing, almost hidden by salt and rust.

Under the star was a tiny compartment. Inside lay an old whistle and a second note: 'For foggy nights, when light is not enough.' Jai smiled. The mystery was not treasure at all. It was a clever safety plan left by someone who cared about every ship coming home.

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Page 2 - Questions and written response

Warm Up - Quick check

Circle the type of text: Story / Information text / Poem

Build Your Skills

1. Where did Jai find the lighthouse?

2. What did Elsie find behind the loose brick?

3. Why did lighthouse keepers use lanterns?

4. What clue helped Jai and Elsie know where to look next?

5. What was inside the tiny compartment?

6. What can you infer about the person who left the notes?

Reading Challenge

Was the mystery solved in a surprising way? Explain your opinion using evidence from the text.

I Can Checklist

☐ I can read carefully.

☐ I can use evidence.

☐ I can answer in full sentences.

Teacher Feedback

What went well: _____

Next step: _____



High Five!

You followed the clues like a reading detective. Be proud of your careful thinking!

Year 4 Reading Comprehension - The Lighthouse Keeper's Note Answer Key

For teachers, parents and tutors

Warm Up answer: Story or mystery narrative.

Detailed answers

1. The lighthouse stood above the harbour near Jai's aunt's place.
2. She found a folded note with faded writing.
3. They used lanterns to help ships find the harbour safely.
4. The note said to look to the southern star, and Elsie found a metal star on the railing.
5. There was an old whistle and a second note inside.
6. The person was careful and responsible because the notes and whistle were part of a safety plan for ships.

Challenge answer: Accept answers that explain the mystery was surprising because it seemed like treasure but was actually a safety plan.

Parent Tip - At Home

At home, hide a small note with two safe clues. Ask your child to explain which words helped them solve the mystery.

Teacher Tip - In Class

Use a two-column chart: Text Clue and My Inference. Complete the first row together before students answer independently.

Extension Idea

Write your own two-sentence mystery note that includes one clue and one hidden purpose.